

SH.1 Subcontractor Interview Scorecard

One sheet per candidate. Verify license and insurance first — those are pass/fail — then score experience and fit, check the walk-away list, and compare the bids side by side.

Template for general reference — have your attorney review before use. Not legal advice.

Trade / Scope: _____ Interview Date: _____

Company Name: _____ Phone: _____

Contact Person: _____ Email: _____

SECTION A — PASS / FAIL VERIFICATION

Fill this in before you score anything, and verify with the state board and the insurance carrier — not with the sub. Whether a license is required, the dollar threshold that triggers it, and which sole proprietors may skip workers' comp are all set by state law: look yours up before you accept an exemption claim.

License

License #: _____ State: _____ Expires: _____

Verified with licensing board (agency): _____ Date checked: _____

Status: ☐ Current ☐ Expired ☐ Not required for this trade / state

Disciplinary actions on file: ☐ None found ☐ Found (see notes)

Insurance

☐ General liability certificate received from the carrier or agent directly

GL carrier: _____ Policy #: _____

Limit per occurrence \$: _____ Policy expires: _____

☐ Workers' compensation certificate received

WC carrier: _____ Policy expires: _____

Workers' comp: ☐ Carried ☐ Sub claims state exemption — verify

☐ Asked to be named as additional insured

☐ Business name on both certificates matches the name on the bid

Called carrier to confirm policy active — date: _____ Spoke with: _____

SECTION A RESULT: ☐ PASS — continue ☐ FAIL — stop here

SECTION B — EXPERIENCE & FIT (SCORE 1-5)

Score each line 1 (weak) to 5 (strong) from what you saw and heard. A blank is a zero — if you did not ask, you do not know.

Scored Questions

Question	Score (1-5)				
Established business — years in operation, stable crew, real address	1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐
New-construction experience, not remodel work only	1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐
Named three or more comparable projects from the past year, with specifics	1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐
Actually read your plans, and raised a real question or challenge	1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐
Realistic start date and duration — booked out, not free tomorrow	1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐
Knows the inspection sequence for this trade and their first-pass record	1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐
Clear answer on who physically does the work and who supervises it	1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐
Communication: how they will update you, how often, and by what method	1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐
Prices and documents changes in writing before doing the work	1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐
Warranty and callback policy — what is covered, for how long	1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐
Answered honestly about a job that went wrong and how they fixed it	1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐
Spoke respectfully about inspectors, past clients and other trades	1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐
Payment terms tied to milestones, deposit within your state's limits	1 ☐	2 ☐	3 ☐	4 ☐	5 ☐

TOTAL SCORE (of 65): _____ Candidate # of: _____

Guidelines, not a verdict: **under 39** — keep looking; **39-51** — only with clean references; **52 and up** — strong candidate, and still check the references.

SECTION C — WALK-AWAY RED FLAGS

Every box below is a reason to stop, not a point to negotiate. One check outweighs any score in Section B.

- ☐ Asks for a large deposit up front (many states cap residential deposits)
- ☐ Will not give a license number, or works “under someone else's license”
- ☐ Cannot produce a certificate of insurance sent directly by the carrier
- ☐ Certificate looks homemade or altered, or the policy has expired
- ☐ No references, or references you cannot reach
- ☐ Cash only, or wants to be paid without an invoice or receipt
- ☐ “We don't need a permit for this”, or offers to work around the inspector
- ☐ Wants to start immediately and has no other work booked
- ☐ Bid is far below the others and they cannot explain what is excluded
- ☐ Refuses to put the scope of work in writing
- ☐ Pressures you to sign today, or claims the price expires
- ☐ Bad-mouths inspectors, past clients, or the other trades on your job
- ☐ Wants materials paid for and delivered somewhere other than your site

SECTION D — DECISION

VERDICT: ☐ Hire ☐ Backup ☐ Reject

Notes — what stood out, good or bad

Completed by: _____ Date: _____

SECTION E — BID COMPARISON WORKSHEET

Three bids, one written scope

If two bids do not describe the same work, their prices are not comparable — get them re-quoted against your written scope. And when one bid lands well under the others, something is missing from it: a permit, an allowance, haul-off, or the part nobody wants to do. Ask what is excluded, in writing.

Compare the three bids against the same written scope

Item	Bid 1	Bid 2	Bid 3
Company			
Bid date / price good until			
Total price (\$)			
Scope — what is included			
Materials supplied by (sub / owner)			
Exclusions — what is NOT included			
Earliest start date			
Duration / completion date			
Deposit asked (%) and payment terms			
Warranty period			
License + insurance verified (Y / N)			

Bid selected, and why
